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Runius

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(54) **LOCKABLE RECEPTACLE HOLDER**

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This patent is subject to a terminal disclaimer.

(58) **Field of Classification Search**

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See application file for complete search history.

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(2013.01); **A47K 2201/025** (2013.01)

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Primary Examiner — Amy J. Sterling

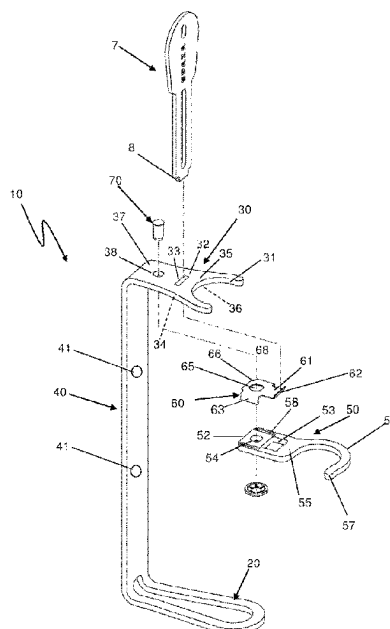
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(57)

ABSTRACT

A receptacle holder may include a holder base portion configured to support the bottom of a receptacle, a holder upper portion and an elongated holder back portion extending between the holder base portion and the holder upper portion. A confining member may be provided to pivot relative the holder upper portion between a closed position (A) for confining the neck and/or the shoulder of the receptacle, and a release position to allow removal of the receptacle from the receptacle holder. A locking member may be provided to prevent movement of the confining member. The locking member may be brought out of engagement with a trough hole by application of a force (F) thereby allowing the confining member to be pivoted relative the holder upper portion.

17 Claims, 5 Drawing Sheets



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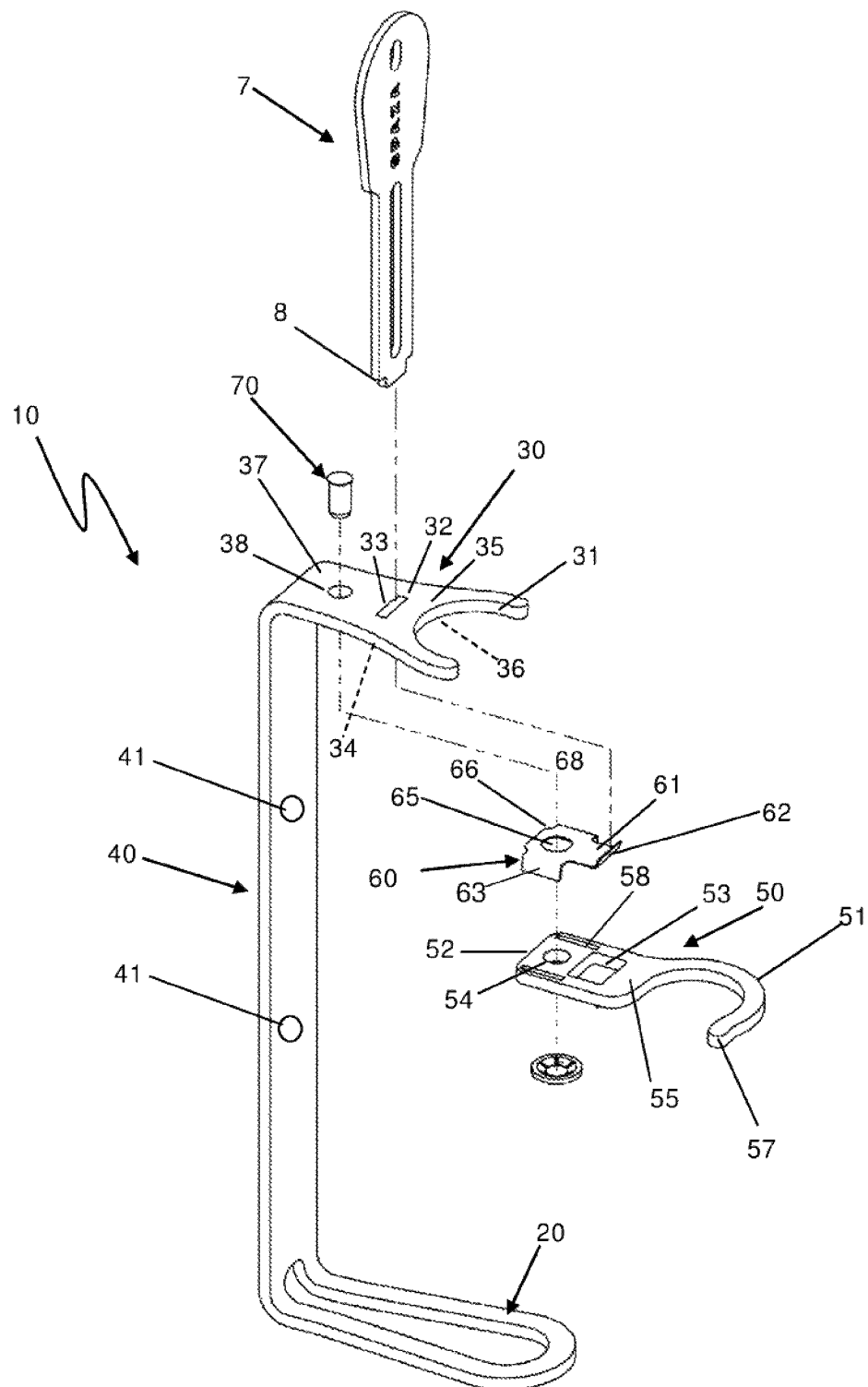
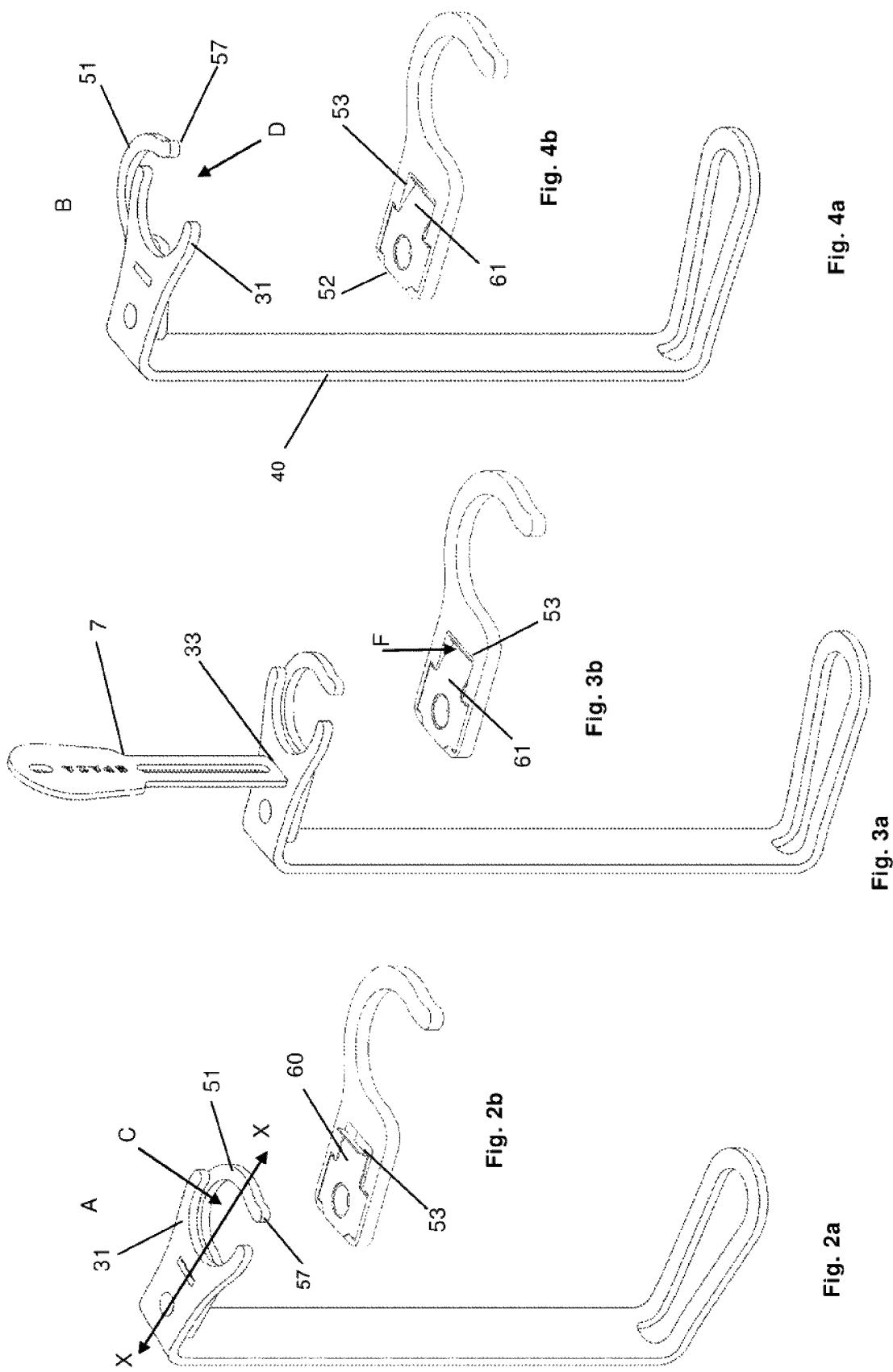


Fig. 1



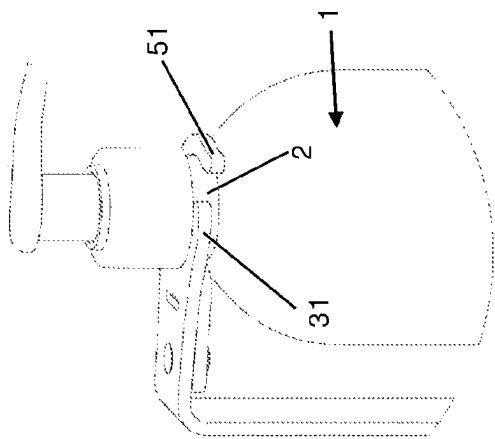


Fig. 7a

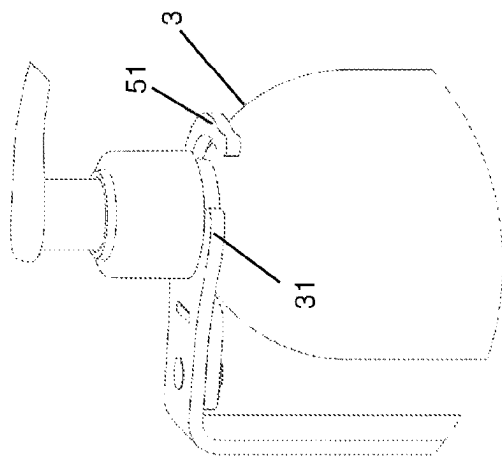


Fig. 7b

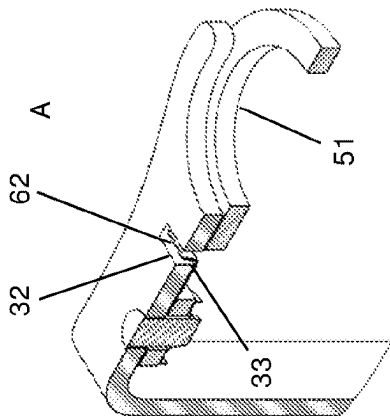


Fig. 5

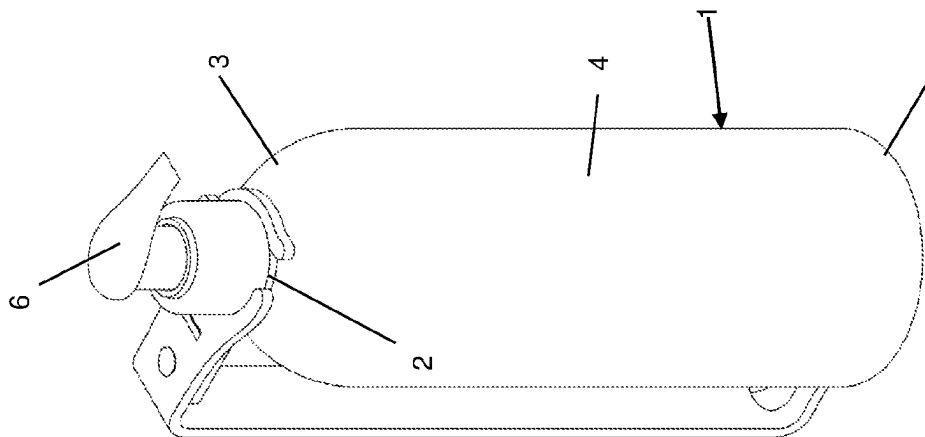


Fig. 6

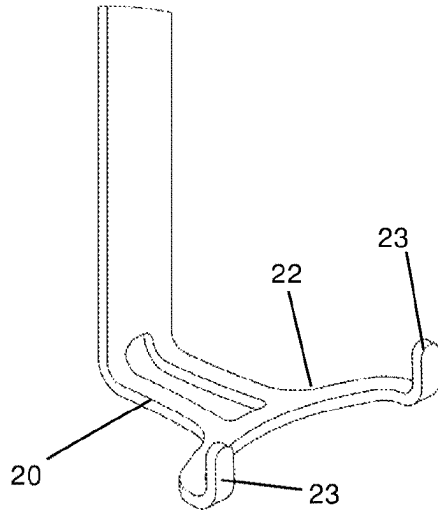


Fig. 8a

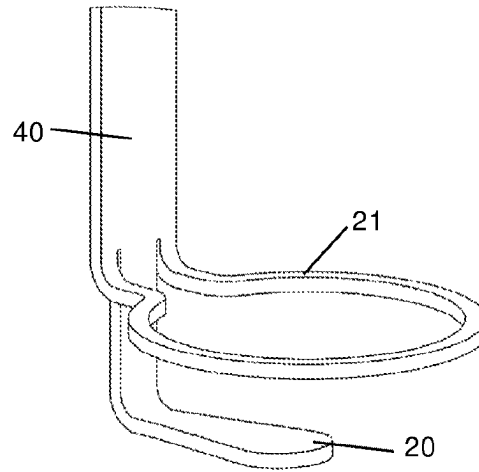


Fig. 8b

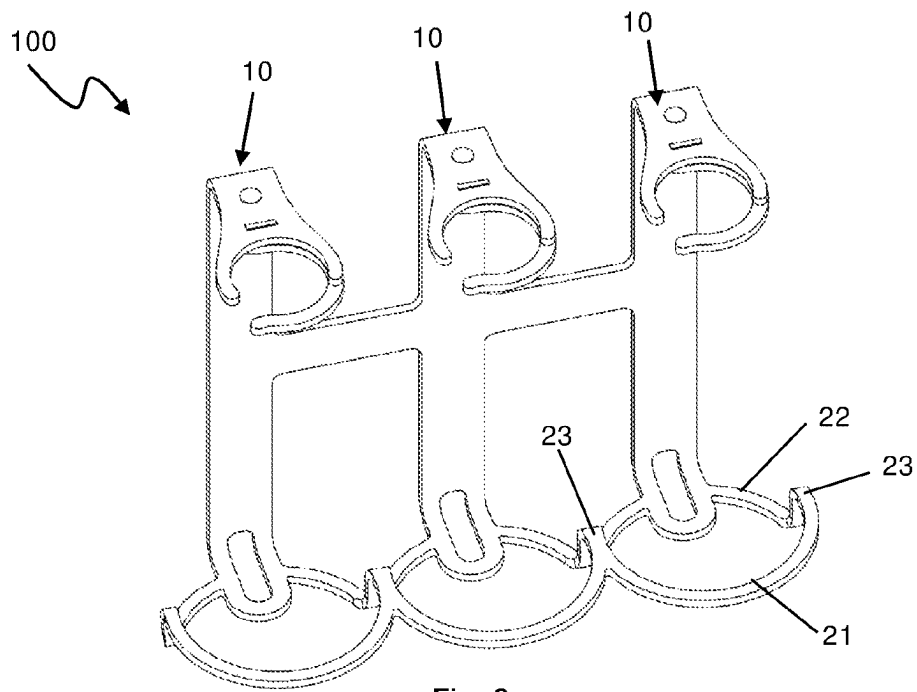


Fig. 8c

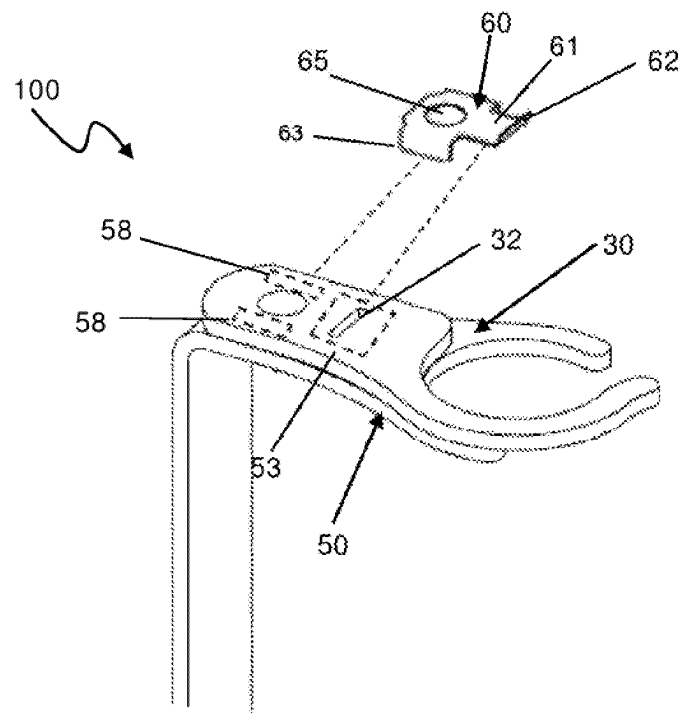


Fig.9

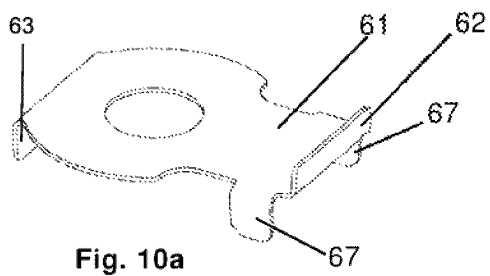


Fig. 10a

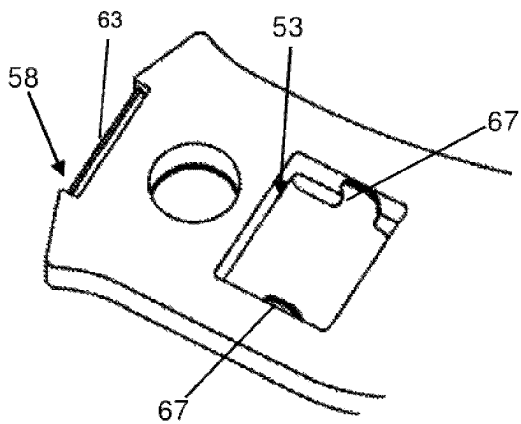


Fig. 10c

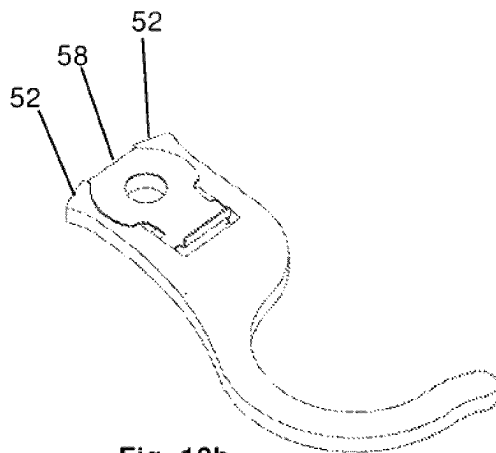


Fig. 10b

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LOCKABLE RECEPTACLE HOLDER

This application is a continuation application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/768,787 filed Apr. 13, 2022, which is a US National Phase Application of International Application No. PCT/SE2020050982 filed Oct. 15, 2020, the entire contents of both of which are incorporated herein by reference.

This application claims priority under 35 USC 119 (a)-(d) to SE patent application No. 1951172-4, which was filed on Oct. 16, 2019, the entire contents of which are incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND**1. Field**

The present disclosure relates to a receptacle holder. In detail a lockable receptacle holder for a dispensing receptacle for dispensing liquid or creamy hygiene products such as soap, shampoo or lotion hand sanitizer

2. Related Art

For environmental reasons, disposable hygiene products such as soap or shampoo in hotel rooms are increasingly being substituted with large volume dispensers. However, a general problem with refillable containers for hygiene products is that they may be subjected to theft or tampering.

To address this problem there are provided holders for hygiene product dispensers with locking mechanisms. One example is US2011/0101196 which shows a holder for a dispensing bottle that is provided with a collar plate that is provided with an opening for receiving the throat of a soap dispenser. The collar plate is guided in two rods that extend from a wall support so that the collar plate may be brought from an inward position in which the collar plate may be locked to an outward position in which the throat of a dispenser bottle may be inserted into the opening of the collar plate.

One drawback with the dispensing bottle holder of US2011/0101196 is that the throat of the dispenser bottle has to be moved in a slanted manner in direction from below in order to insert the throat of the dispensing bottle into the opening of the collar plate. This makes it awkward and time consuming for housekeeping personal to replace or refill the dispenser bottle. A further drawback resides in the locking of the dispenser bottle holder. To lock the dispensing bottle holder, the dispensing bottle and the collar plate has to be pushed rearwards until a notch in the floating locking pin coincides with a corresponding notch in the guide pin. Thereafter the locking pin is turned by the user. This is a time consuming locking process which involves several steps.

A further holder for a dispenser bottle is shown in SE 540307 C2. In this holder the collar plate is attached to the bottle support by screws. Replacement of the dispenser bottle requires removal of the screws and is therefore time consuming.

Thus, it is an object of the present disclosure to provide a receptacle holder which solves at least one of the problems of the prior art.

In particular, it is and object of the present disclosure to provide a lockable receptacle holder which allows for fast and easy removal and replacement of a receptacle in few working steps.

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A further object is to provide a receptacle holder which provides a lockable receptacle holder which provides high resistance to unauthorized removal of a receptacle.

A further object of the present disclosure is to provide a lockable receptacle holder which may be manufactured at low cost.

SUMMARY

At least one of these objects are met by a lockable receptacle holder **10** comprising a holder base portion **20** configured to support the bottom **5** of a receptacle **1**; a holder upper portion **30** and an elongated holder back portion **40** extending between the holder base portion **20** and the holder upper portion **30** characterized in:

a confining member **50** having a hook-shaped front portion **51** and pivotally attached to the holder upper portion **30** so that the confining member **50** may pivot relative the holder upper portion **30** between a closed position A in which the hook-shaped front portion **51** and the holder upper portion **30** form an at least partially closed space C for confining the neck **2** and/or the shoulder **30** of a receptacle **1**, and a release position B in which the hook-shaped front portion **51** and the holder upper portion **30** are spaced apart to allow removal of a receptacle **1** from the receptacle holder **10**; a locking member **60** attached to one of the holder upper portion **30** and the confining member **50** and having a locking portion **61** configured to be received into one opening **33,34** of a through hole **32** in the other of the holder upper portion **30** and the confining member **50** when the confining member **50** is in the closed position A, thereby preventing movement of the confining member **50** wherein,

the locking portion **61** is resilient so that it may be brought out of engagement with the trough hole **32** by application of a force F, optionally onto the locking portion **61** optionally through the other opening **33, 34** of the through hole **32**, thereby allowing the confining member **50** to be pivoted relative the holder upper portion **30**.

The lockable receptacle holder is tamper resistant and allows for secure holding of receptacle. In practice, the hook-shaped confining member may easily be unlocked by inserting a purposely dimensioned tool, optionally into the through hole, to apply a force F unto the locking portion. Subsequently the confining member is pivoted to the side thereby allowing house-keeping personnel to easily remove the receptacle for exchange or refilling. Removal and replacement of the receptacle is easy, demands no tricky handling of the receptacle and may be performed in little time.

The receptacle holder comprises few parts and is easy to assemble. It is also easy to clean and durable. Cyclic tests have shown that the components of the receptacle holder maintain structural integrity over 7000 cycles at 9 kg pressure.

The holder upper portion **30** of the receptacle holder **10** may comprises an arcuate front portion **31** for receiving a portion of a neck **2** or shoulder **3** of a receptacle **1**. The arcuate front portion provides a secure support for the receptacle during operation of the confining member. Preferably, the hook-shaped front portion **51** of the confining member **50** may be rounded to form an at least partially closed circular space C with the front end **31** of the holder upper portion **30**.

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The through hole 32 may be configured to receive an end portion 8 of a tool 7 wherein the cross-sectional shape of the through hole 32 and the end portion 8 of the tool 7 may be configured such that end portion 8 of the tool 7 may pass through the through hole 32. This provides the possibility to customize the through hole so that the locking portion only may be accessed by special tools. Thus, unauthorized opening of the receptacle holder may be prevented or made difficult.

The one of the holder upper portion 30 and the confining member 50 to which the locking member 60 is attached may comprise a receiving opening 53 for receiving the locking portion 61 of the locking member 60 when the locking portion 61 is brought out of the through hole 32. This allows for usage of a flat and thin locking portion, which in turn provides for a compact and tamper resistant receptacle holder 9. The locking portion 61 may thereby be elongate, flat and provided with an upright edge 62 to be received in the through hole 32. For example, the locking portion is a part of a locking member 60 in the form of an integral piece of resilient steel strip.

A particularly compact and tamper resistant the receptacle holder 10 is provided when the confining member 50 and the locking member 60 and the holder upper portion 30 are superimposed and the through hole 32 and the locking portion 61 and the receiving opening 53 are aligned so that the locking portion 61 of the locking member 60 may be pushed into the receiving opening 53 by an end portion 8 of a tool 7 that is inserted through the other opening 33, 34 of the through hole 32. Such a receptacle holder may be realized in that the locking member 60 is arranged underneath the holder upper portion 30 and the confining member 50 is arranged underneath the locking member 60 and wherein through hole 32 extends between an upper opening 33 on an upper side 35 and a lower opening 34 on a lower side 36 of the of the holder upper portion 30.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

Non-limiting embodiments will become more fully understood from the detailed description below and the accompanying drawings, wherein like elements are represented by like reference numerals, which are given by way of illustration only and thus are not limiting of the present invention.

FIG. 1 is a schematic drawing showing an exploded view of a receptacle holder according to the present disclosure.

FIGS. 2a, 2b, 3a, 3b, 4a, and 4b are schematic drawings illustrating the function of the receptacle holder according to the present disclosure.

FIG. 5 is a sectional view of a portion of the receptacle holder according to the present disclosure.

FIG. 6 is a schematic drawing showing a receptacle holder according to the present disclosure and a receptacle.

FIGS. 7a and 7b are schematic drawings showing receptacle holders according to alternatives of the present disclosure.

FIGS. 8a, 8b, and 8c are schematic drawings showing alternative base portions of the receptacle holder according to the present disclosure.

FIG. 9 is a schematic drawing of a receptacle holder according to an alternative of the present disclosure.

FIGS. 10a, 10b, and 10c are schematic drawings of alternative locking member and confining member of the present disclosure.

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DESCRIPTION OF NON-LIMITING EMBODIMENTS

The receptacle holder according to the present disclosure will now be described more fully hereinafter. The receptacle holder according to the present disclosure may however be embodied in many different forms and should not be construed as limited to the embodiments set forth herein. Rather, these embodiments are provided by way of example so that this disclosure will be thorough and complete, and will fully convey the scope of the present disclosure to those persons skilled in the art. Same reference numbers refer to same elements throughout the description.

A "receptacle" or "container" is configured to hold liquid, semi-liquid, creamy or paste-formed substances. Typically a receptacle is a bottle or a jar and has a neck, with a mouth, a shoulder, a body and a bottom. The receptacle may comprise a dispenser which is inserted into the mouth of the receptacle. The dispenser allows a user to pump out the content of the dispenser. The receptacle may in such case be denominated "dispenser receptacle". FIG. 6 shows a receptacle 1 in the form of a bottle with a dispenser 6. The receptacle has a neck 2, a shoulder 3, a body 4 and bottom 5.

In the following description of the receptacle holder according to the present disclosure it is appreciated that the receptacle holder may be realized in different sizes and dimensions to fit receptacles of varying shape, size and dimension. Thus, when the receptacle holder, in the following is described with reference to a receptacle or parts thereof, it is appreciated that the receptacle holder is dimensioned in view of that receptacle.

Further in the following description, any references to directions such as "upright", "upwards", "downwards" or "lateral" are in relation to a vertical orientation of the receptacle holder in which the holder base is below the holder upper portion.

FIG. 1 shows an exploded view of a lockable receptacle holder 10 according to the present disclosure. The receptacle holder 10 comprises an elongated holder back portion 40 which may be configured to be attached to a structure such as a wall (not shown). Attachment of the holder back portion 40 to the structure may for example be achieved by double sided adhesive tape or by screws (not shown) through the openings 41. The holder back portion 40 extends between a holder base portion 20 and a holder upper portion 30. Thus, the holder base portion 20 may extend from one end of the holder back portion 20. The holder upper portion 30 extends opposite to the holder base portion 20. The holder base portion 20 is configured to support the bottom 5 of a receptacle (not shown). In FIG. 1 the holder base portion 20 therefore extends approximately perpendicular from the holder back portion 40 and has a width and a length sufficient to support the bottom 5 of a receptacle 1.

The holder upper portion 30 may extend from a second end of the holder back portion 40. The holder upper portion 30 may thereby extend approximately parallel with the holder base portion 20. The front portion 31 of the holder upper portion 30 points away from the holder back portion 40. The distance between the holder upper portion 30 and the holder base portion 20 may be selected such that the front end 31 of the holder upper portion faces the neck or shoulder of a receptacle that is supported on the holder base portion 20. The front end 31 of the holder upper portion 30 may be configured to receive a portion of the neck or shoulder of a receptacle that is supported on the holder base portion 20. In FIG. 1, the front end 31 of the holder upper portion 30 is

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arcuate, i.e. has an arc-shaped recess. However, the front end 31 of the holder upper portion 30 may have a square or triangular recess. In the embodiment shown in FIG. 1, the holder upper portion 30 comprises a through hole 32 that extends between an upper opening 33 on the upper side 35 of the holder upper portion 30 and a lower opening 34 on the lower side 36 of the holder upper portion. The through hole 32 is dimensioned such that a locking portion 61 of a locking member 60 may be received through the lower opening 34 and such that at least the end portion 8 of a tool 7 may be inserted through the upper opening 33. The cross-section of the end portion 8 of the tool 7 may thereby have the same or smaller dimensions as the cross-section of the through hole 32. The cross-sectional shape of the end portion 8 of the tool 7 and/or the tip 8 of the cross-sectional shape of the through hole may be same or similar. For example, as shown in FIG. 1, the through-hole 32 may be of rectangular cross-section and the end portion of the tool 7 may also be of rectangular cross-section. The length of the end portion 8 of the tool 7 is selected such that the end portion 8 extends through or flush with the lower opening 34 of the through hole.

A shaft opening 38 for a pivot shaft 70 is provided in the rear portion 37 of the holder upper portion 30. The rear portion 37 is located between the through hole 32 in the holder upper portion 30 and the holder back portion 40.

The receptacle holder 10 further comprises a confining member 50 which has a hook-shaped front portion 51 and a rear portion 52 which may be rectangular. The hook-shaped front portion 51 has a front end 57, i.e. a free front end 57. In FIG. 1, the hook-shaped front portion 51 is rounded, however it may also have other configuration such as triangular—or rectangular hook-shape. The confining member 50 is pivotally attached to the holder upper portion 30. The confining member may thereby pivot relative the holder upper portion 30 in a plane that is parallel to the width and length extension of the holder upper portion 30. The confining member 50 may thereby be pivotally attached to a pivot shaft 70 that extends through a shaft opening 54 in the rear portion 52 of the confining member 50 and the shaft opening 38 in the holder upper portion 30. In the described embodiment, the confining member 50 comprises a receiving opening 53 that is provided in the rear portion 52 of the confining member 50. For example, the receiving opening 53 is provided between the shaft opening 54 and the hook-shaped front portion 51 of the confining member 50. The receiving opening 53 may be a through-hole or a recess, and is configured to receive a locking portion 61 of a locking member 60.

The locking member 60 comprises a locking portion 61 and a rear portion 66 from which the locking portion 61 may extend. The locking portion 61 is configured to extend into the through hole 32 in the holder upper portion 30. The locking portion 61 may therefore be elongated and have an upright edge 62. That is, directed in direction away from the upper surface of the locking member 60. In the shown embodiment, the locking portion 61 is a flat. However, the locking portion 61 may have other configuration, for example rod-shaped. It is also possible to divide the locking portion 61 in to two locking portion halves (not shown). In the shown embodiment, the locking member 60 is configured to be attached to the rear end of the confining member 50. The rear portion 66 of the locking member 60 may therefore have attachment means 63 in the form of parallel flanges that may be inserted into corresponding openings 58, such as grooves in the confining member 50. Alternatively, the locking member 60 may glued or welded to the confining

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member 50. The locking portion is resilient. For example, the locking member 60 or at least the locking portion 61 is manufactured from resilient material such as resilient steel strip such as spring steel. Alternatively, plastic material such as polypropylene may be used, for example.

The locking member 60 may be arranged such that the locking portion 61 extends over the receiving opening 53 in the confining member 50.

The rear portion 66 of the locking member 60 may comprise an opening 65 for the pivot shaft 70. The pivot shaft may be a press pin that is riveted into the holder upper portion 30. The end of the pivot shaft may be secured by a rivet locking collar or by a nut and washer (not shown).

In assembled state, the confining member 50 and the locking member 60 and the holder upper portion are superimposed and the through hole 32 and the locking portion 61 and the receiving opening 53 are aligned so that the locking portion 61 of the locking member 60 may be pushed into the receiving opening 53 by a tool 7 inserted through the upper opening 33 of the through hole 32. As shown in FIG. 1, the locking member 60 is arranged underneath the holder upper portion 30 and the confining member 50 is arranged underneath the locking member.

The function of the receptacle holder 10 according to the present disclosure will in the following be described with reference to FIGS. 2a, 2b-4a, 4b and 5.

FIG. 2a shows the assembled receptacle holder 10 in a position A in which the front portion 31 of the holder upper portion 30 and the hook-shaped front portion 51 of the confining member 50 limits a partially closed space C which is configured to confine the neck or shoulder of a receptacle (not shown in FIG. 2). By “confine” is meant that any opening between the front portion 31 of the holder upper portion 30 and the end 57 of the hook-shaped front portion 51 of the confining member 50 is too small to allow passage of a neck or shoulder of a receptacle. FIG. 5 shows a cross-sectional view taken along line X-X in FIG. 2a. Thus, when the confining member 50 is in position A, the upright edge 62 of the locking portion 61 of the locking member 60 extends into the lower opening 33 of the through hole 32. The locking portion 61 therefore locks the confining member 50 and prevents any pivotal movement thereof. FIG. 2b shows the locking portion 61 extending over, but not beyond, the receiving opening 53 in the confining member 50.

FIG. 3a shows the tool 7 inserted into the upper opening 33 of the through opening 32. The tip 8 of the tool 7 thereby exerts a force F onto the upright edge 62 of the locking portion 61 and presses the locking portion 61 downwards into the receiving opening 53 (see FIG. 3b). When the upright edge 62 has been pushed out of the through hole 32, the confining member 50 is released to pivot relative the holder upper portion 30. In the described embodiment, as shown in FIG. 5, the holder upper portion 30, the locking member 60 and the confining member 50 are superimposed with essentially no gap between them. The tool 7 may therefore be configured such that the end portion 8 thereof merely extend through the through hole 32. This will suffice to force the upright edge 62 of the locking portion 60 into the receiving opening 53 so that the upright edge 62 is flush with the upper surface 55 of the confining member. The confining member 50 will thereby be released to pivot.

However, it is possible to arrange the holder upper portion 30 and the confining member 50 superimposed with a gap between them (not shown). In this case, the tip 7 of the tool 6 may be elongated to extend through the through hole 32 and through the gap between the holder upper portion 30 and

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the confining member 50 in order to force the edge 62 of the locking portion 61 out of the through hole and into the receiving opening 53.

It is further possible to arrange the holder upper portion 30 and the confining member 50 superimposed with a gap that is wide enough to accommodate the edge 62 of the locking portion. In that case the receiving opening 53 in the confining member 50 may be omitted (not shown).

FIG. 4a shows the receptacle holder 10 in a situation where the confining member 50 is pivoted relative to the holder upper portion 30 to a release position B. In this position, the end 57 of the hook-shaped front portion 51 is spaced apart from the front portion 31 of the holder upper portion 30 such that an opening D is formed between the end 57 of the hook-shaped front portion 51 and the front portion 31 of the holder upper portion 30. The opening D is sufficiently large to allow removal of a receptacle (not shown) from the receptacle holder. Thus, the opening D is sufficiently large to allow passage of the neck or shoulder of the receptacle. The upright edge 62 of the locking portion is in sliding contact with the lower surface 36 of the holder upper portion 30 during pivoting from the locked position A to the release position B. The rear portion 52 of the confining member 50 may be arranged such that it hits the holder back portion 40 when the confining member 50 is in the release position B which prevents further pivoting of the confining member 50. This is favorable because the locking portion 61 may be kept in contact with the lower side of the holder upper portion which in turn may prevent damage of the locking portion when the confining member is pivoted towards the closed position A.

A receptacle 1 may be inserted and locked into the receptacle holder 10 by performing the steps described above in reversed order.

Although a particular embodiment has been disclosed in detail this has been done for purpose of illustration only, and is not intended to be limiting. In particular, it is contemplated that various substitutions, alterations and modifications may be made within the scope of the appended claims.

For example, the receptacle holder 10 according to the present disclosure has hereinabove been described in an embodiment in which the holder upper portion 30 comprises the through hole 32 and the confining member 50 comprises the receiving opening 53 and wherein the locking member 60 is attached to the confining member 50. In the described embodiment, the confining member 50 is arranged underneath the holder upper portion 30.

However, it is possible that the confining member 50 is arranged above the holder upper portion 30.

FIG. 9 shows an alternative in which the confining member 50 is arranged above the holder upper portion 30 and the locking member 60 is arranged between. For comparison it is referred to FIG. 1. FIG. 9 is partly exploded in order to show the position and orientation of the locking member 60.

According to the alternative, the confining member 50 may thereby comprise the through hole 32 for accessing the upright edge 62 of the locking member 60. The holder upper portion 30 may comprise the receiving opening 53 for receiving the locking portion 61 of the locking member 60 and openings 58 for receiving the attachment means 63 of the locking member 60, i.e. the flanges. The described openings in the holder upper portion 30 are indicated by dashed lines since they are partly obscured by the confining member 50. Thus in assembled state, the locking member 60 is attached to the upper holder portion 30 by engagement of the attachment means 63 with the openings 58 in the holder

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upper portion 30. As shown in FIG. 1, a pivot shaft (not shown) may extend through the confining member 50, the locking member 60 and the holder upper portion 30.

In FIG. 1, the locking member is attached to the confining member 50 by engagement between the attachment means 63 of the locking member 60 and the openings 58 in the confining member 50. In FIG. 9, the locking member 60 is attached to the upper holder portion 30 by engagement of the attachment means 63 of the locking member with the openings 58 in the holder upper portion 30. Thus, the locking member 60 may be attached to one of the holder upper portion 30 and confining member 50.

The confining member 50 may be mirror-inverted and arranged to pivot in opposite direction than shown FIG. 4a.

Also alternatives for the confining member 50 and the locking member 60 are feasible. In the following alternatives for confining member 50 and locking member 60 are described relative the receptacle support shown in FIG. 1.

FIG. 10a shows a locking member 60 according to an alternative of the present disclosure. According to this alternative, the attachment means 63 is provided as a flange at the rear end of the locking member 60 opposite to the locking means 62. The locking member 60 may further be provided with two support legs 67 that extend from the locking portion 61. The attachment means 63 and the support legs 67 protrude vertically in the same direction from the flat surface of the locking member 60. The locking means 62 protrudes in the opposite direction.

FIG. 10b shows the locking member 60 and an alternative confining member 50 in assembled state. The rear portion of the alternative confining member 50 is rounded, which results in a tight abutment with the holder back portion (not shown) during pivoting of the confining member 50. In particular, this makes it difficult pivot beyond the locking member. FIG. 10c shows the support legs 67 extending through the opening 53 in the confining member 50. The support legs 67 engages with the sides of the opening 53 and prevents thereby side movement of the locking portion 61.

It is further possible to arrange the holder upper portion 30 such that the arcuate front portion 31 is oriented 90° to the facing direction of the holder back portion (not shown). The receptacle may thereby be introduced from the side of the receptacle holder.

Also further alternatives or modifications of the receptacle holder 10 according to the present disclosure are feasible. For example:

FIG. 7a shows a configuration in which the hook-shaped front portion 51 extends partially around the neck 2 of a receptacle 1. FIG. 7b shows a configuration in which the hook-shaped front portion 51 extends partially around the shoulder 3 of a receptacle 1. In FIGS. 7a and 7b, the arcuate front portion 31 of the holder upper portion 30 is configured to receive a portion of the neck 2 of the receptacle 1. However, the front portion 31 of the holder upper portion 30 may be configured to receive a portion of the shoulder 3 of a receptacle 1 (not shown).

The holder receptacle 10 may comprise retainer elements for holding the body or the bottom of a receptacle in order to further prevent lateral movement of a receptacle in the receptacle holder. For example, as shown in FIG. 8a, the holder base portion 20 may comprise an arcuate lateral extension 22 having upright retainer pins 23 in each end. In use, the retainer pins 23 engage the bottom of a receptacle. FIG. 8b shows a retainer element 21 in the form of a ring, which extends from the holder back portion 40 above the holder base portion 20. The ring shaped retainer element is configured to hold the body of a receptacle.

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The present disclosure also relates to a receptacle holder unit **100** comprising two or more receptacle holder **10** that are joined together. FIG. **8c** shows a receptacle holder unit **100** comprising three receptacle holder **10**. In FIG. **8c**, the receptacle holder unit is integrally formed. However, it is possible to join two or more receptacle holder **10** to each other (by e.g. welding) to achieve a receptacle holder unit. FIG. **8c** also shows a further alternative of a retainer element **21**. The holder base portion comprises a first arcuate lateral extension **22** that extends in a concave manner from the holder base portion **20** and that has upright pins **23** in each end. A retainer element **21** in the form of a ring segment extends convexly between the upright pins and may thereby engage the body of a receptacle.

Moreover, although specific terms may be employed herein, they are used in a generic and descriptive sense only and not for purposes of limitation. Furthermore, as used herein, the terms “comprise/comprises” or “include/includes” do not exclude the presence of other elements. Finally, reference signs in the claims are provided merely as a clarifying example and should not be construed as limiting the scope of the claims in any way.

What is claimed is:

1. A receptacle holder comprising:
 - a holder base portion configured to support a bottom of a receptacle;
 - a holder upper portion;
 - an elongated holder back portion extending between the holder base portion and the holder upper portion;
 - a confining member having a hook-shaped front portion and pivotally attached to the holder upper portion, such that the confining member is pivotable relative the holder upper portion between a closed position in which the hook-shaped front portion and the holder upper portion form an at least partially closed space for confining a neck and/or a shoulder of the receptacle, and a release position in which the hook-shaped front portion and the holder upper portion are spaced apart to allow removal of the receptacle from the receptacle holder; and
 - a locking member attached to one of the holder upper portion and the confining member, the locking member having a locking portion configured to be received into a first opening of a through hole in the other of the holder upper portion and the confining member when the confining member is in the closed position, thereby preventing movement of the confining member; wherein the locking portion is resilient, such that it is disengageable from the through hole by application of a force, thereby allowing the confining member to pivot relative to the holder upper portion.
2. The receptacle holder according to claim 1, wherein the holder upper portion comprises an arcuate front portion for receiving a portion of the neck or the shoulder of the receptacle.
3. The receptacle holder according to claim 2, wherein the hook-shaped front portion of the confining member is rounded to form a partially closed circular space with a front end of the holder upper portion.
4. The receptacle holder according to claim 1, wherein the through hole is configured to receive an end portion of a tool; and

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wherein the through hole and the end portion of the tool are configured such that at least the end portion of the tool is passable through the through hole to apply the force onto the locking portion.

5. The receptacle holder according to claim 1, wherein the one of the holder upper portion and the confining member to which the locking member is attached comprises a receiving opening for receiving the locking portion of the locking member when the locking portion disengages from the through hole.

6. The receptacle holder according to claim 5, wherein the confining member and the locking member and the holder upper portion are superimposed and the through hole and the locking portion and the receiving opening are aligned so that the locking portion of the locking member may be pushed into the receiving opening by an end portion of a tool that is inserted through a second opening of the through hole.

7. The receptacle holder according to claim 6, wherein the locking member is arranged underneath the holder upper portion and the confining member is arranged underneath the locking member; and

wherein the through hole extends between an upper opening on an upper side and a lower opening on a lower side of the of the holder upper portion.

8. The receptacle holder according to claim 1, wherein the confining member is pivotally attached to the holder upper portion by a pivot shaft extending through a rear portion of the holder upper portion and a rear portion of the confining member.

9. The receptacle holder according to claim 1, wherein the locking member is an integral piece of resilient steel strip.

10. The receptacle holder according to claim 1, wherein the locking portion is elongate, flat and has an upright edge to be received in the through hole.

11. The receptacle holder according to claim 1, wherein the locking portion comprises two locking portion halves.

12. The receptacle holder according to claim 1, wherein the locking member is configured to be attached to a rear end of the confining member.

13. The receptacle holder according to claim 8, wherein a rear portion of the locking member comprises an opening for the pivot shaft.

14. The receptacle holder according to claim 1, wherein the holder base portion comprises retainer pins that are configured to engage the bottom of the receptacle, or wherein the receptacle holder comprises a retainer element in the form of a ring that is configured to hold a body of the receptacle.

15. The receptacle holder according to claim 1, wherein the locking portion is disengageable from the through hole by application of a force onto the locking portion.

16. The receptacle holder according to claim 15, wherein the locking portion is disengageable from the through hole by application of a force onto the locking portion through a second opening of the through hole.

17. A receptacle holder unit comprising two or more receptacle holders according to claim 1 that are joined together.

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